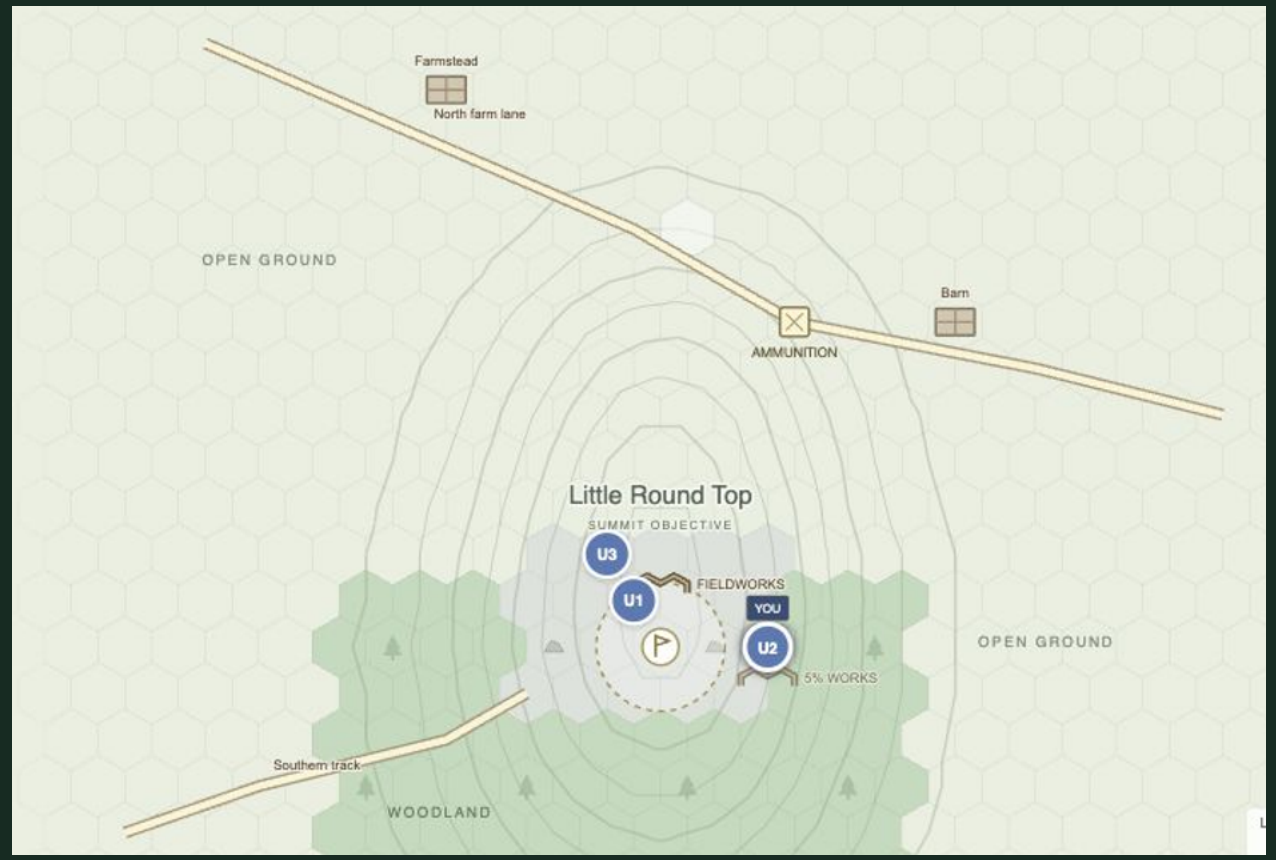
battle

Six small actions and Cannae

Give orders from the information your headquarters has. See how a courier, a shouted command or a missed signal changes what the troops can do.



Little Round Top • screenshot from the playable prototype

SIX ERAS / ONE ARMY-SCALE TEST

AMERICAN CIVIL WAR

Little Round Top

Gettysburg, Pennsylvania / July 2, 1863



AI reconstruction of Company B, 20th Maine

Company B, 20th Maine, on the exposed Union flank. Confederate pressure comes from the neighboring Alabama infantry.

How far can a detached company range and still protect the line?

ORDERS TO TEST

Union: Screen the exposed flank. Take cover and use local judgment when the enemy passes.

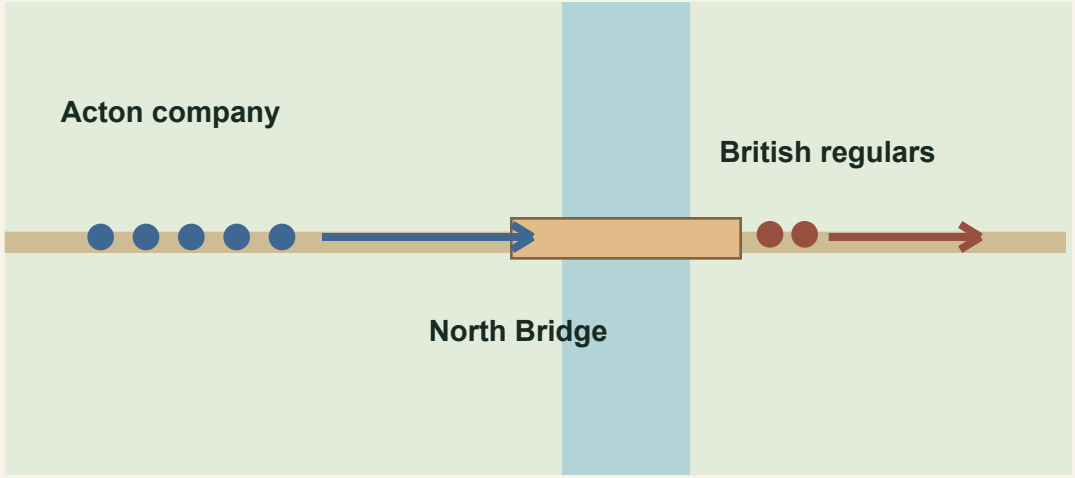
Confederate: Advance against the Union left. Withdraw when the position becomes untenable.

RECORDED OUTCOME

The Union held the position. Morrill described firing from a stone wall as the Confederates fell back.

Concord’s North Bridge

Concord, Massachusetts / April 19, 1775



Schematic of the action • positions and distances are illustrative

Captain Isaac Davis’s Acton minute company at the head of a larger provincial column, facing British light infantry at the crossing.

When may the front company open fire?

ORDERS TO TEST

Provincial: Advance to the bridge. Hold fire until fired upon, then return fire on Buttrick’s command.

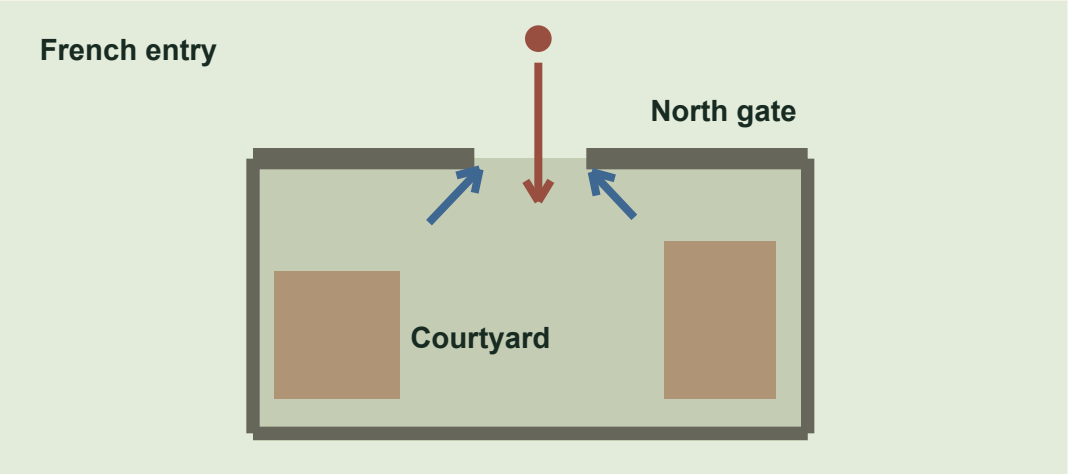
British: Guard the crossing. Fall back toward the main body if the position gives way.

RECORDED OUTCOME

The regulars fired, the provincials returned fire, and the regulars withdrew. Davis was killed.

The north gate at Hougoumont

Waterloo, present-day Belgium / June 18, 1815



Schematic of the action • positions and distances are illustrative

Guards defending the farm and a French assault party. The gate fight was a small action within the wider garrison defence.

When is it worth closing the route that keeps the garrison supplied?

ORDERS TO TEST

Allied: Keep the supply entrance available. On a breach, close the leaves and hold the courtyard.

French: Reach the entrance and pass men through before the defenders can shut it.

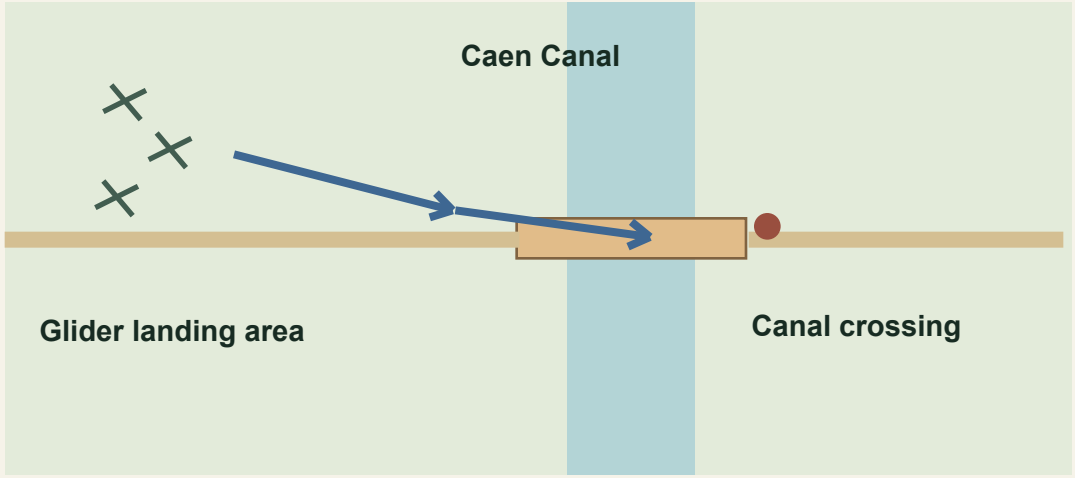
RECORDED OUTCOME

A French party entered. The defenders shut the gate behind them and held the farm through the day.

WORLD WAR II

Pegasus Bridge

Bénouville, Normandy / June 6, 1944



Schematic of the action • positions and distances are illustrative

Major John Howard’s reinforced D Company, 2nd Ox and Bucks. The case follows the canal-bridge platoons of the wider two-bridge operation.

Can the first platoons seize the crossing intact before the defence can react?

ORDERS TO TEST

British: Land near the canal bridge, rush the crossing and hold it intact for relief.

German: Guard the crossing, raise the alarm and organize resistance when the landing is detected.

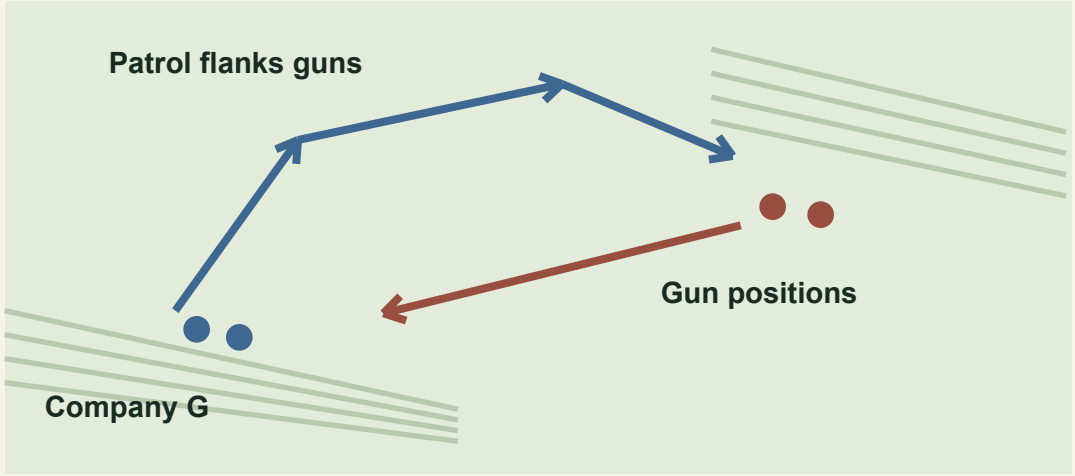
RECORDED OUTCOME

The British captured the canal bridge intact. The Orne river bridge was a separate objective.

WORLD WAR I

The ravine west of Hill 223

Châtel-Chéhéry, France / October 8, 1918



Schematic of the action • positions and distances are illustrative

Company G, 328th U.S. Infantry. The maneuvering element is Sgt. Bernard Early's 17-man patrol, nested in a company attack.

Can a small patrol turn a gun position that has stopped the main advance?

ORDERS TO TEST

American: Send a patrol around the flank to reach the machine guns from the rear.

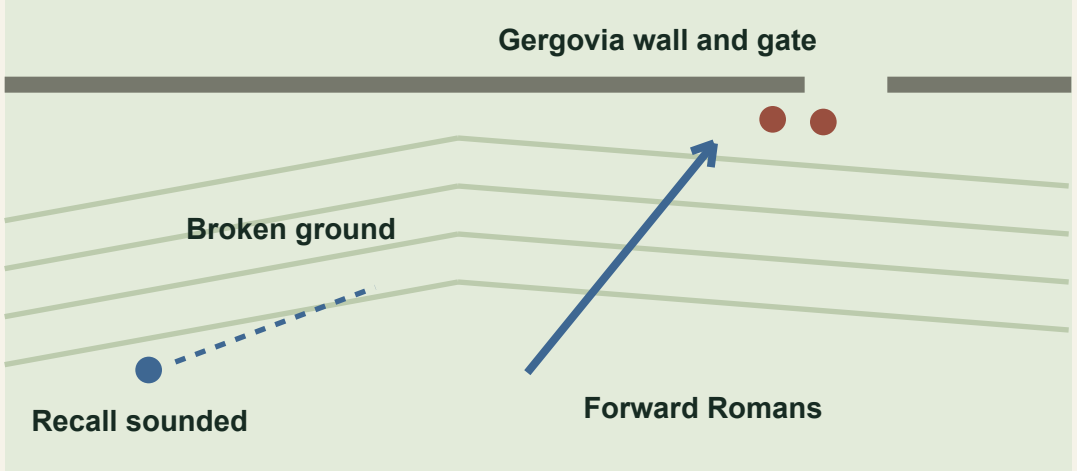
German: Keep the approach under fire. Respond locally when the patrol reaches the gun positions.

RECORDED OUTCOME

The patrol suffered losses, captured German troops and brought prisoners back. The outcome depended on more than one man.

The recall at Gergovia

Gaul, present-day France / 52 BCE



Schematic of the action • positions and distances are illustrative

Men of the Eighth Legion under centurions at the wall, against Gallic defenders. The comparison is a small sector of a much larger assault.

What does a forward detachment do when the recall fails to reach it?

ORDERS TO TEST

Roman: Attack the outer position, then halt and retire on the recall. Each group acts on the signals it receives.

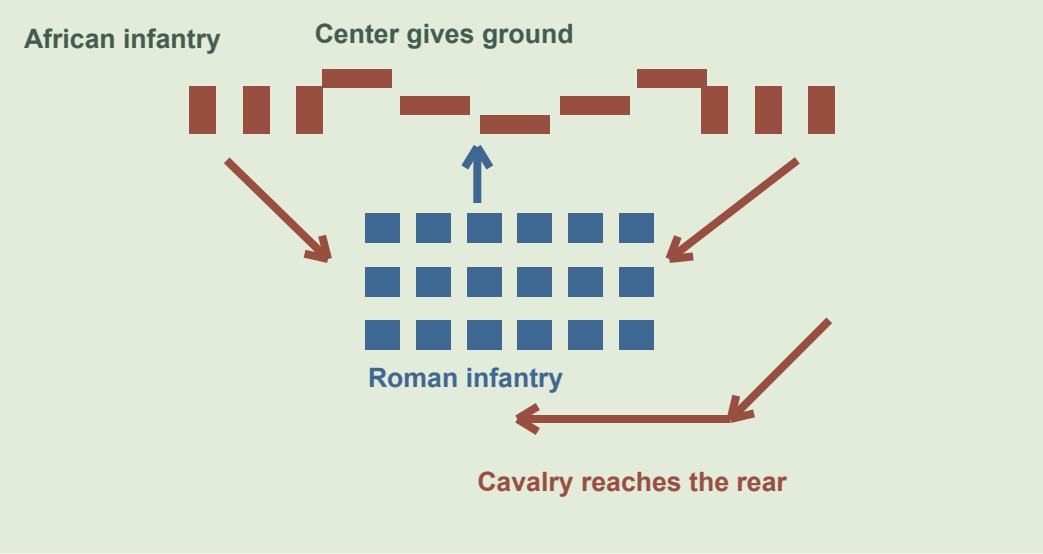
Gallic: Reinforce the threatened wall and gate. Drive back the isolated Romans.

RECORDED OUTCOME

Caesar says some troops continued after he sounded the recall. Defenders repulsed the attack. His account gives the Roman commander's perspective.

Cannae: can the Romans still get out?

Apulia, Italy / 216 BCE



Maneuver diagram • direction and spacing are illustrative

Hannibal's center yielded under Roman pressure. African infantry turned onto both flanks, and cavalry attacked from the rear.

WHAT TO MEASURE

Can a Roman formation still find a passable lane? Track each wing's facing, local orders, crowding and how many troops can escape before the rear closes.

COUNTERFACTUAL

Delay the cavalry or hold back a Roman reserve. Compare escapes and closure times with the baseline.

Four synthetic route checks passed. The full Cannae simulation is pending. Across the six smaller cases, six shared component checks passed. The Gettysburg demo replayed exactly across 63 revisions.